

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET C — NCERT EXEMPLAR, IN-TEXT SOURCES & TRICKY QUESTIONS****CHAPTER 05: STATE AND SOCIETY UP TO 1000 CE**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-C-05

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET C - NCERT Exemplar & Tricky Questions):

1. The question paper comprises **25 NCERT Exemplar & Critical Application Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Tests **in-text source boxes, fine glossary definitions, historical source extracts, and tricky boundary cases**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **NCERT IN-TEXT & EXEMPLAR TIER:** Questions in this set explore subtle details, specialized definitions, and non-intuitive concepts drawn directly from official NCERT text margins, source boxes, and glossary entries.

Q.1 In the **Rigveda**, which Mandala contains the famous 'Purusha Sukta' hymn that describes the metaphorical cosmic creation of the four **Varnas**?

- | | |
|------------------|-----------------|
| (A) 10th Mandala | (B) 1st Mandala |
| (C) 3rd Mandala | (D) 7th Mandala |

Q.2 Which of the 16 ancient Mahajanapadas was the **ONLY** state located south of the Vindhya mountain range along the Godavari River basin?

- | | |
|----------------------|------------|
| (A) Assaka (Ashmaka) | (B) Avanti |
| (C) Chedi | (D) Matsya |

Q.3 In Kautilya's Mauryan administrative framework, what was the official designation of the Chief Collector-General responsible for assessing and collecting royal revenue?

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| (A) Samaharta | (B) Sannidhata |
| (C) Dharmasthiya | (D) Pradeshtri |

Q.4 What did the term 'Vishti' denote in the economic and administrative records of the Gupta Empire?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Forced, unpaid labor extracted from peasants and artisans as a form of state taxation | (B) A royal gold coin distributed during religious festivals |
| (C) A special tax on foreign ocean merchant vessels | (D) A ceremonial gift given by kings to newlywed couples |

Q.5 According to the famous Uttaramerur inscription of Chola King Parantaka I, what was an essential educational qualification required for a candidate contesting village committee elections?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Proficiency in the sacred Vedic mantras and their commentaries, alongside being between 35 and 70 years of age and owning taxable land | (B) Fluency in speaking modern English and French |
| (C) A degree from a European university | (D) An ability to recite texts while standing on one foot |

Q.6 Under the Uttaramerur inscription, which disqualification permanently barred a resident from contesting the Chola village committee (*Variyam*) elections?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Having served on a committee previously without submitting certified accounts of public expenditure | (B) Being unable to swim across the village pond |
| (C) Owning more than five cows | (D) Having travelled on a wooden bullock cart |

Q.7 In Mauryan intelligence and espionage under Kautilya, what was the distinction between 'Sanstha' and 'Sanchara' spies?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) 'Sanstha' were stationary secret agents stationed in specific posts (monasteries, markets, courts); 'Sanchara' were mobile wandering spies operating across regions | (B) 'Sanstha' were foreign diplomats; 'Sanchara' were military cavalry captains |
| (C) 'Sanstha' were trained birds; 'Sanchara' were guard dogs | (D) Both terms refer to royal cooks in the palace kitchen |

Q.8 The famous play *Mrichchhakatika* (The Little Clay Cart), depicting life in ancient Ujjain, was authored by the classical playwright:

- | | |
|----------------|--------------|
| (A) Sudraka | (B) Kalidasa |
| (C) Bhavabhuti | (D) Bhasa |

Q.9 What did the agrarian term 'Brahmadeya' signify in ancient and early medieval Indian socio-economic history?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) A tax-free grant of cultivated land or entire villages bestowed by royalty upon learned Brahmins and scholars | (B) Land owned exclusively by royal cavalry officers for horses |
| (C) A barren desert tract reserved for military training exercises | (D) Land purchased by foreign Roman traders |

Q.10 In the court of Gupta Emperor Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya), the group of nine celebrated scholars, poets, and scientists were collectively honored as the:

- | | |
|----------------------------|-------------------|
| (A) Navaratnas (Nine Gems) | (B) Ashtadiggajas |
| (C) Ashtapradhan | (D) Panchatantra |

Q.11 Which Sanskrit lexeme is used in ancient Sangam literature to describe the fertile agricultural river valley ecoculture among the five classical landscapes (*Thinai*)?

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| (A) Marutham | (B) Kurinji |
| (C) Mullai | (D) Neythal |

Q.12 What unique medical treatise on surgery, detailing rhinoplasty (nasal reconstruction), cataract removal, and over 120 surgical instruments, was composed by ancient physician:

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--------------|
| (A) Sushruta (*Sushruta Samhita*) | (B) Charaka |
| (C) Patanjali | (D) Vagbhata |

Q.13 In the administration of the Mauryan Empire, which officer was in charge of weights, measures, and marketplace consumer protection?

- | | |
|---------------------|--------------------|
| (A) Pautavadhyaksha | (B) Sitadhyaksha |
| (C) Navadhyaksha | (D) Lavanadhyaksha |

Q.14 The ancient Buddhist university of Vallabhi (Valabhi), which flourished as a major center of Hinayana learning, was located in modern-day:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----------|
| (A) Gujarat (Saurashtra) | (B) Bihar |
| (C) Odisha | (D) Assam |

Q.15 What was the term used in ancient Indian economic guilds for the supreme head or president of a merchant guild (*Shreni*)?

- | | |
|-------------------------|---------------|
| (A) Jetthaka / Sresthin | (B) Samaharta |
| (C) Yuvaraja | (D) Senapati |

Q.16 In ancient South India, the celebrated Tamil epic *Silappadikaram* (The Tale of an Anklet), telling the story of Kannagi and Kovalan, was composed by:

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------------|
| (A) Ilango Adigal | (B) Tiruvalluvar |
| (C) Kambar | (D) Chithalai Chathanar |

Q.17 What was the administrative unit 'Bhukti' in the Gupta provincial administrative hierarchy?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) A major imperial province governed by a royal governor called an *Uparika* | (B) A single village street lined with shops |
| (C) A military naval warship operating in the Bay of Bengal | (D) A tax on agricultural cattle |

Q.18 The Chinese Buddhist traveler Fa-Hien noted with astonishment in the early 5th century CE that throughout northern India:

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) The state did not impose the death penalty, roads were peaceful, and people did not consume onions, garlic, or intoxicating liquor | (B) Every citizen was imprisoned for ten years upon reaching adulthood |
| (C) All private houses were built of solid gold blocks | (D) The king executed half the population every winter |

Q.19 What was the primary function of the 'Ghatika' in early medieval South Indian education and culture?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) An elite collegiate institution of higher Sanskrit, philosophical, and Vedic learning, often attached to prominent royal temples | (B) A water clock used to measure the height of ocean waves |
| (C) A tax levied on bullock carts crossing river bridges | (D) A specialized weapon carried by Chola archers |

Q.20 Which Mauryan rock edict is famous for expressing Emperor Ashoka's deep remorse and sorrow immediately following the catastrophic Kalinga war?

- | | |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Major Rock Edict XIII | (B) Major Rock Edict I |
| (C) Pillar Edict VII | (D) Minor Rock Edict III |

Q.21 What was the 'Kudavolai' pot system of the Cholas physically composed of during the balloting process?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) Palm-leaf chits inscribed with candidate names bundled together and drawn out of a sealed earthen pot in front of the entire village assembly | (B) Small golden coins stamped with royal crests |
| (C) Carved wooden dice rolled on a stone gaming board | (D) Paper ballots printed with modern machine ink |

Q.22 In ancient Indian metallurgical history, what was 'Wootz Steel' produced in southern India (Tamil Nadu/Karnataka/Telangana) celebrated for worldwide?

- (A) Ultra-high carbon crucible steel with distinctive swirling Damascus water patterns, exported across the ancient world to forge legendary swords
- (B) A soft lead metal used exclusively to make children's toys
- (C) An alloy of copper and gold that dissolved in water
- (D) A metal manufactured exclusively in the year 1800

Q.23 Which ancient Indian legal text, composed in refined Sanskrit couplets, codified the classical Hindu laws on inheritance, kingship, and civil conduct?

- (A) Manusmriti (Manava Dharmashastra)
- (B) Aryabhatiya
- (C) Kamasutra
- (D) Natya Shastra

Q.24 What does the term 'Pattinam' denote as a suffix in ancient South Indian urban geography (e.g., Kaveripattinam, Nagapattinam)?

- (A) A busy coastal port town or maritime commercial city
- (B) A mountain hill station covered in snow
- (C) A dense forest inhabited only by hunters
- (D) A private royal bedroom in a palace

Q.25 Why was Emperor Kanishka of the Kushana dynasty depicted on his gold coins holding a spear and offering incense at a small fire altar?

- (A) It visualized his syncretic imperial ideology, combining Central Asian warrior identity with Persian Zoroastrian fire veneration and Indian royal legitimacy
- (B) He was shown cooking meat in the palace kitchen
- (C) He was burning foreign books by imperial law
- (D) He was demonstrating how to extinguish a campfire

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET C)

01 (A) (B) (C) (D)	02 (A) (B) (C) (D)	03 (A) (B) (C) (D)	04 (A) (B) (C) (D)	05 (A) (B) (C) (D)
06 (A) (B) (C) (D)	07 (A) (B) (C) (D)	08 (A) (B) (C) (D)	09 (A) (B) (C) (D)	10 (A) (B) (C) (D)
11 (A) (B) (C) (D)	12 (A) (B) (C) (D)	13 (A) (B) (C) (D)	14 (A) (B) (C) (D)	15 (A) (B) (C) (D)
16 (A) (B) (C) (D)	17 (A) (B) (C) (D)	18 (A) (B) (C) (D)	19 (A) (B) (C) (D)	20 (A) (B) (C) (D)
21 (A) (B) (C) (D)	22 (A) (B) (C) (D)	23 (A) (B) (C) (D)	24 (A) (B) (C) (D)	25 (A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET C)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.1	(A)	The Purusha Sukta occurs in the 10th Mandala of the Rigveda, describing the metaphorical emergence of the four Varnas from the cosmic being Purusha.
Q.2	(A)	Assaka (with its capital at Potana/Bodhan) was the southernmost Mahajanapada situated along the banks of the Godavari River in modern Maharashtra/Telangana.
Q.3	(A)	Under the Arthashastra, the *Samaharta* was the supreme fiscal officer in charge of revenue assessment and collection across the empire, while the *Sannidhata* was the Chief Treasurer.
Q.4	(A)	*Vishti* was unpaid forced labor extracted by the state or feudal land-grant beneficiaries from rural villagers and craftsmen for public works and military logistics.
Q.5	(A)	Uttaramerur rules: candidates had to be between 35 and 70 years of age, own more than 1/4 *veli* of land, live in a house built on their own site, and possess Vedic and Dharmashastric learning.
Q.6	(A)	Failure to render transparent public accounts during a previous committee term disqualified the individual and all their close relatives from future elections.
Q.7	(A)	Kautilya divided the espionage apparatus (*Gudhapurushas*) into *Sanstha* (stationary institutions disguised as monks, merchants, or ascetics) and *Sanchara* (itinerant roving agents).
Q.8	(A)	Sudraka's *Mrichchhakatika* is a masterwork of Sanskrit dramatic realism, capturing the romance between the impoverished merchant Charudatta and courtesan Vasantasena in ancient Ujjain.
Q.9	(A)	*Brahmadeya* was land alienated by kings to Brahmins, exempt from royal taxes (*Sarvaparihara*), serving to expand settled agriculture and Vedic cultural influence into frontiers.
Q.10	(A)	Chandragupta II's court at Ujjain boasted the legendary *Navaratnas* (Nine Gems), including Kalidasa, Varahamihira, Amarasimha, Dhanvantari, and Vararuchi.
Q.11	(A)	The Sangam five-fold landscape (*Thinai*): Kurinji (mountains), Mullai (forests/pastures), Marutham (fertile agrarian plains), Neythal (coastal seashore), and Palai (arid wilderness).
Q.12	(A)	Sushruta is hailed as the 'father of surgery': the *Sushruta Samhita* describes plastic surgery, operative instruments, surgical incisions, and wound disinfection in ancient India.
Q.13	(A)	The *Pautavadhyaksha* was the Superintendent of Standard Weights and Measures, inspecting commercial scales and standardizing weights to prevent market fraud.
Q.14	(A)	Vallabhi in Saurashtra (Gujarat), patronized by the Maitraka dynasty, was an international Buddhist university renowned for administrative and medical sciences alongside Nalanda.
Q.15	(A)	Merchant and artisan guilds were led by a hereditary or elected chief known as the *Jetthaka* (elder) or *Sresthin* (prominent merchant-banker).
Q.16	(A)	Prince-ascetic Ilango Adigal composed *Silappadikaram*, narrating Kannagi's quest for justice against the Pandya king of Madurai over her husband Kovalan's wrongful execution.
Q.17	(A)	The Gupta Empire was divided into provinces called *Bhuktis* governed by *Uparikas*; *Bhuktis* were further subdivided into districts called *Vishayas* under *Vishayapatis*.
Q.18	(A)	Fa-Hien observed Gupta peace and prosperity: governance was mild without corporal execution, and Buddhist ahimsa influenced broad vegetarian habits in urban centers.
Q.19	(A)	*Ghatikas* (like the famous Ghatika of Kanchipuram under the Pallavas) were renowned collegiate centers of higher theological, legal, and philosophical debates.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.20	(A)	Major Rock Edict XIII expresses Ashoka's profound grief over the slaughter of 100,000 people and deportation of 150,000 in Kalinga, proclaiming his shift to conquest by righteousness.
Q.21	(A)	The Uttaramerur inscription details: palm-leaf tickets (*Kudavolai*) carrying candidates' names were bundled and placed into an earthen pot (*Kuda*), then picked by a young boy.
Q.22	(A)	Wootz (from Tamil *urukku* / Kannada *ukku*) was high-carbon crucible steel exported across the Indian Ocean to Damascus, famed for hardness and sharp cutting edges.
Q.23	(A)	The *Manusmriti* is the most widely cited classical legal treatise (*Dharmashastra*), compiling customary jurisprudence, varna-ashrama duties, and kingly justice (*Rajadharma*).
Q.24	(A)	In ancient Tamil urban typology, *Pattinam* specifically denoted a flourishing maritime port settlement engaged in coastal and trans-oceanic shipping.
Q.25	(A)	Kushana numismatic iconography was cosmopolitan and syncretic, depicting the emperor in nomadic dress making offerings at altars while featuring Greek, Zoroastrian, and Indian deities.